- *Unaware*—No ownership, security, or systems defined for data
- *Aware*—Project-oriented strategy, efforts to document the data-related risks begun, siloed information consolidation
- *Reactive*—Formalized objectives for information sharing, localized integrations, and point-to-point interfaces
- *Proactive*—The data governance team established, data-related policies adhered to, locally maintained data models aligned with central architecture guidance
- *Managed*—Cross-functional information problems addressed by the data governance body, enterprise-level approach to information needs
- *Efficient*—Automated data governance seamless information flows

If your company is at early maturity stages (e.g., either aware or not), implementing federated data governance may require a lot of time and effort.

KEY POINT Data mesh is easier to implement in companies of high data governance maturity.

DATA-SAVVY SOFTWARE ENGINEERS

Even if your software development teams are mature, their world is separated from the world of data in many companies. In such a case, the (mis)communication between these worlds often creates bottlenecks in data operations. If your company engineers are already data savvy, the evolution of data products from existing systems should be a quick and easy process. Otherwise, when planning a transition to a data mesh, you need to consider the competence gap you'll have to fill.

Suppose your company already hires apt data engineers. You will still need to develop a strong platform team to prepare a user-friendly environment for joint software and data development teams to form. You will also need to build a strong enabling team to mentor these teams.

If your software development team has insufficient experience working with data, and you also lack experienced data engineers, you may need to consider recruiting data-savvy engineers. This cost can be added to your calculations.